PROJECT TIMELINE

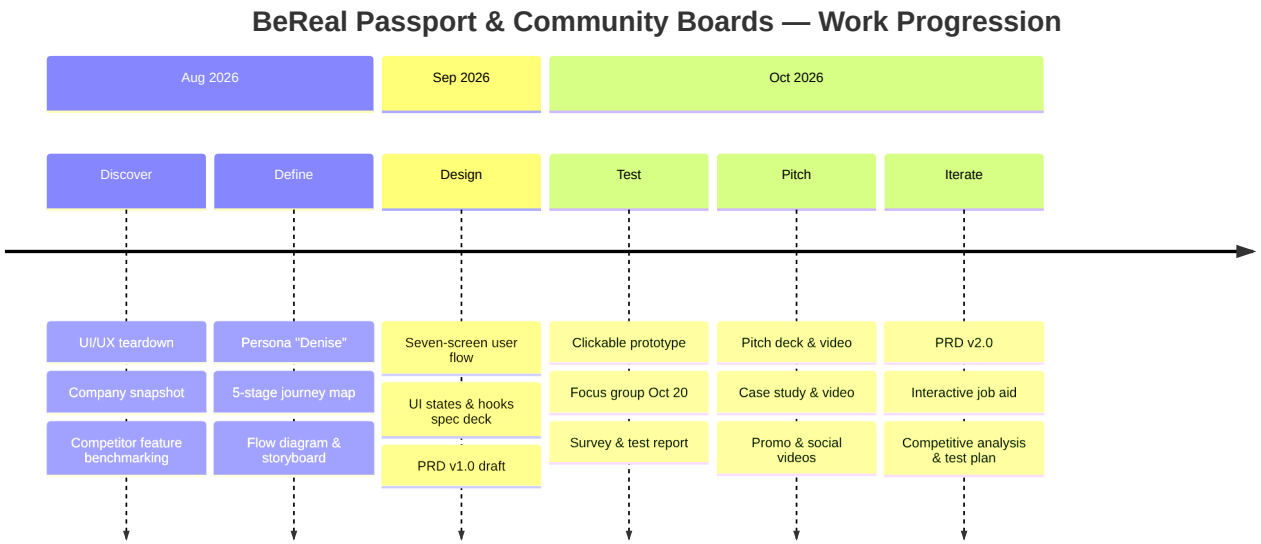
BeReal Passport & Community Boards — Project Timeline

Live prototype · PRD v2.0 · Test Plan · Back to README

> *Independent concept created for a UI/UX Design & Product Management Externship. Not affiliated with or endorsed by BeReal.*

Summary

The project ran from **August to October 2026**, from a teardown of the current app to a tested, pitched and revised feature. The biggest turning point was the **October 20 focus group**: it validated the direction (**4 of 5** would open BeReal more often) and surfaced the main friction (**too many taps**), which reshaped the requirements, the rollout plan and the test plan that followed.



Milestones

When	Phase	Milestone	Artifact
Aug 2026	1. Discover	UI/UX teardown of the current app and a company snapshot	Teardown (PDF) · Snapshot
Aug 2026	1. Discover	Benchmarked the retention features of TikTok and BeReal	Competitive Analysis

When	Phase	Milestone	Artifact
Aug 2026	2. Define	Persona "Denise" and 5-stage journey map; flow diagram and storyboard	Persona & Journey · User Journey folder
Sep 2026	3. Design	Seven-screen user flow, UI states and re-engagement hooks in the spec deck	Prototype folder
Sep 2026	3. Design	**PRD v1.0**: 1-pager and full requirements, drafted before testing	PRD v1.0
Oct 2026	4. Prototype & test	Clickable prototype built from the spec deck with Claude	Live prototype · Prompt engineering
Oct 2026	4. Prototype & test	Focus group plan, discussion guide and 8-question survey	Survey folder
Oct 20	4. Prototype & test	**Focus group**: 5 participants, 3 tasks, think-aloud plus survey	Testing & Results
Oct 21	4. Prototype & test	Repo created; prototype published on GitHub Pages	Live prototype
Oct 22	4. Prototype & test	Survey results, focus group notes and observer notes	Survey results
Oct 24	5. Pitch	Test summary report, pitch narrative and evidence pack	Pitch folder
Oct 25	5. Pitch	**Pitch deck and 5-minute pitch video**	▶️ Pitch video
Oct 25–26	5. Pitch	**Case study deck and 16-minute video**; promo reel and social cuts	▶️ Case study · ▶️ Promo reel
Oct 27	6. Revise requirements	**PRD v2.0**: test results added; rollout re-phased to "refine, then retest"	PRD process & changes
Oct 27	7. Enable users	Interactive job aid, step-list spreadsheet and reusable prompt	Job aid · Process & prompt
Oct 27	8. Strategy	Competitive analysis, feature working session and A/B test plan	Competitive Analysis · Working Session · Test Plan

August and September milestones are shown by month. Dates from October 20 onward come from the case study and the repo's commit history.

How the plan changed along the way

Moment	What I learned	What changed
Benchmarking (Aug)	Competitors win daily habits with pressure: endless feeds, public likes, loss-framed streaks	Set guardrails: authentic, opt-in, low pressure, friends-only

Moment	What I learned	What changed
Design (Sep)	Taking the photo had to stay as fast as it is today	Put the board choice *after* the photo, as a layer on top
Focus group (Oct 20)	The risk wasn't pressure; it was **complexity**	Top fix became "cut taps from capture to stamp"
PRD v2.0 (Oct 27)	Five testers show direction, not proof	Rollout re-phased: refine and retest before building an MVP; A/B test plan added

Up next

These phases come from PRD v2.0 and the Test Plan. No dates are set yet.

Phase	Plan	Exit criteria
1. Refine & retest	Cut taps, clarify SEND vs. COMMUNITY BOARD, add a first-use explainer; retest with 7–10 people	≤ 3 taps from shutter to stamp; ≥ 80% task success
2. MVP + A/B test	One board, full loop, squad-randomized experiment over 8 weeks	Active days +5% for casual users, no guardrail breached
3. Full rollout	Four themed boards a month, plus shorter observance boards	Sustained lift after the novelty wears off
4. Sponsored pilot	Sponsor-branded boards and stamps	Brand-safety review passed; no drop in trust